



First Flight to the Sun

NASA will launch the Parker Probe, humanity's first mission to the sun, from the Kennedy Space Centre in June. <https://digit.in/nasasun>



SpaceX's rendezvous with a balloon

Elon Musk plans to use a "giant party balloon" to recover second stage of rockets and land on a bouncy house. <https://digit.in/spacex>

THE DIET CHART

We take a look at some of popular fad diets and figure out what makes them click.

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Be it the fitness regimes of the modern times or the culinary wisdom of a time gone by, diets have always played an important role in human health. Back in 1826, Anthelme Brillat-Savarin, in *Physiologie du Gout, ou Meditations de Gastronomie Transcendante*, wrote: "Dis-moi ce que tu manges, je te dirai ce que tu es." (Tell me what you eat and I will tell you what you are). While he certainly didn't intend his quote to be taken literally, much of it is true when it comes to the health of the human body. That is why most fitness instructors, regardless of which one they choose, will prescribe a particular or customised diet to go along with your fitness regime. There are plenty of popular ones - some that have risen in popularity momentarily and some that have stayed there. But there's a lot more to know about these diets - especially in terms of the misinformation that goes around with them.

Juice

What: It includes no biting or chewing, only drinking.

Details: A diet with a highly restricted calorie intake, the Juice diet focusses not only on losing weight but also detoxing your organs like the liver and the stomach. Some juice diets also include some solid food. Extreme juice diets that do not allow solid food last for a shorter duration.

How you can go about it: There are numerous juice diet plans out there. Pick one based on what you like the most and also based on whether or not you want to include solid foods into your diet.

Pros:

- High consumption of essential fruits and vegetables.
- Some evidence (<https://digit.in/juicediet>) indicates improvement in gut health.
- Reduces produce waste.

Cons:

- There is no scientific evidence to prove its efficacy.
- Essential fibre, Protein, iron and fat, all essential to the body, will be missing from this diet.
- This diet can get expensive.
- The juice diet causes increased sugar levels.

Paleo

What: If the caveman didn't eat it, you won't either.

Details: Ushering dieting away from counting calories, Paleo focuses on eating the right food. This diet blames agriculture and the consumption of grain and sugar for the worsening of the human physiology as compared to the people of the paleolithic times. It does not put any restrictions on how much you can eat as compared to what you can eat.

How to go about it: There are three simple rules to follow for the Paleo diet - no sugar, no grains and no processed food. Unless your sugar is coming from a fruit, forget about it. Paleo purists stay away from dairy as well. You'll also need to drop legumes and refined oil. So what can you eat? Contrary to what you might think, there's a lot of options. You can have things like steak with asparagus and sweet potato fries, grilled chicken salad, massive omelets to fill you up for the whole morning, apples dipped in almond butter, and so on and so forth.

Pros:

- The Paleo Diet does not restrict food quantity.
- Reducing the input of processed food, sugar and salt is universally good.

Cons:

- It doesn't account for the fact that human digestion has also evolved significantly since paleolithic times. In fact, it is based on the assumption that our genetic makeup has evolved little since, which is not the case.
- Calcium deficiency, mainly due to lack of dairy products in the diet, can prove to be significantly worrisome.